

NOTE 02 — SOC ANALYST LEVELS: L1, L2 AND L3

SOC Analyst Levels

SOC teams commonly divide analyst responsibilities into different levels.

Titles and responsibilities can vary between organizations, but L1/L2/L3 is a useful general model.

Level	Main role	Typical responsibility
L1	Alert Triage	Monitor and validate alerts
L2	Investigation	Perform deeper investigation
L3	Advanced Analysis	Handle complex incidents and improve detection

L1 — SOC Analyst

L1 is generally the first level of security alert handling.

Core responsibilities

- Monitor alerts.
- Review SIEM dashboards.
- Perform initial triage.
- Determine whether an alert appears legitimate.
- Check IP addresses, domains, usernames, timestamps, and processes.
- Gather initial evidence.
- Categorize alerts.
- Escalate suspicious or complex cases.

Example

Suppose the SIEM generates:

Multiple failed login attempts

Source IP: 10.10.10.50

Target: Windows Server

Attempts: 35

The L1 analyst may:

1. Check the source IP.
2. Check the affected account.
3. Review authentication logs.
4. Check whether the behavior is expected.
5. Look for successful login after failures.
6. Escalate if suspicious.

L2 — SOC Analyst

L2 analysts perform deeper investigations.

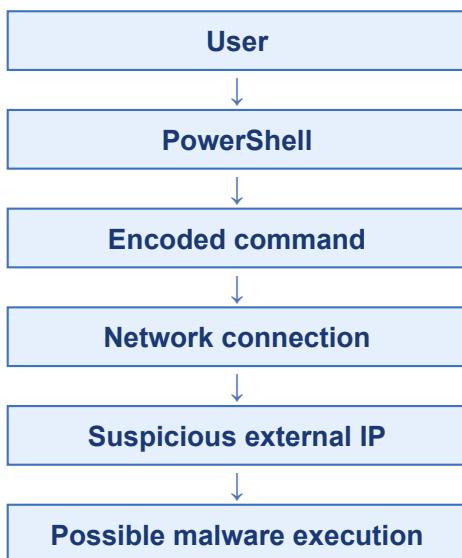
Core responsibilities

- Investigate escalated alerts.
- Correlate multiple logs.
- Analyze endpoint activity.
- Investigate suspicious processes.
- Analyze network connections.
- Identify attack techniques.
- Determine scope and impact.
- Recommend containment actions.
- Communicate with other security teams.

Example

An L1 analyst identifies suspicious PowerShell activity.

L2 may investigate:



L3 — Advanced SOC / Security Analyst

L3 analysts generally deal with advanced investigations and security improvement.

Core responsibilities

- Advanced threat hunting.
- Complex incident investigation.
- Malware analysis.
- Detection engineering.
- Advanced forensic analysis.
- Create or improve detection rules.
- Investigate sophisticated attacks.
- Support incident response.
- Research advanced attacker techniques.

Example

An L3 analyst may investigate an advanced intrusion involving:

- Initial access
- Credential theft
- Lateral movement
- Persistence
- Command and control
- Data exfiltration

L1 vs L2 vs L3

Feature	L1	L2	L3
Alert monitoring	High	Sometimes	Sometimes
Initial triage	High	Yes	Yes
Basic investigation	High	High	High
Advanced investigation	Limited	High	Very high
Threat hunting	Limited	Some	High
Malware analysis	Limited	Some	Advanced
Detection engineering	Limited	Some	High
Incident response	Escalates	Participates	Advanced
Typical experience	Beginner	Intermediate	Advanced

TryHackMe describes L1 analysts as junior members who triage alerts and pass complex cases to L2; L2 analysts investigate more advanced attacks, while specialized experts and engineers handle deeper security functions. TryHackMe

Conclusion

The three levels work together rather than independently:

